

Advancing Health Equity and Optimal Health for All

2016 ASTHO President's Challenge

Edward P. Ehlinger, MD, MSPH

Commissioner, Minnesota Department of Health

President, Association of State and Territorial Health Officials (ASTHO)

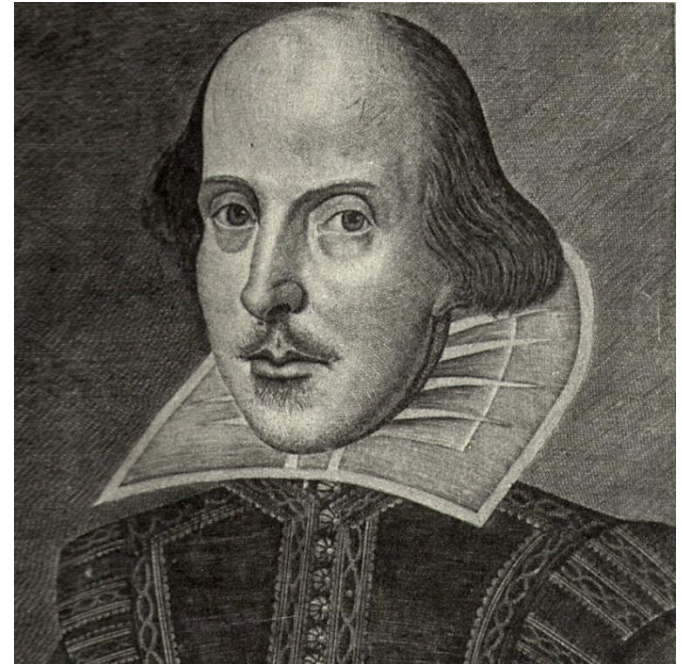
January 6, 2016

Twelfth Night

by William Shakespeare

Shakespeare died 400 years ago this year

- *“Be not afraid of greatness. Some are born great, some achieve greatness, and others have greatness thrust upon them”*

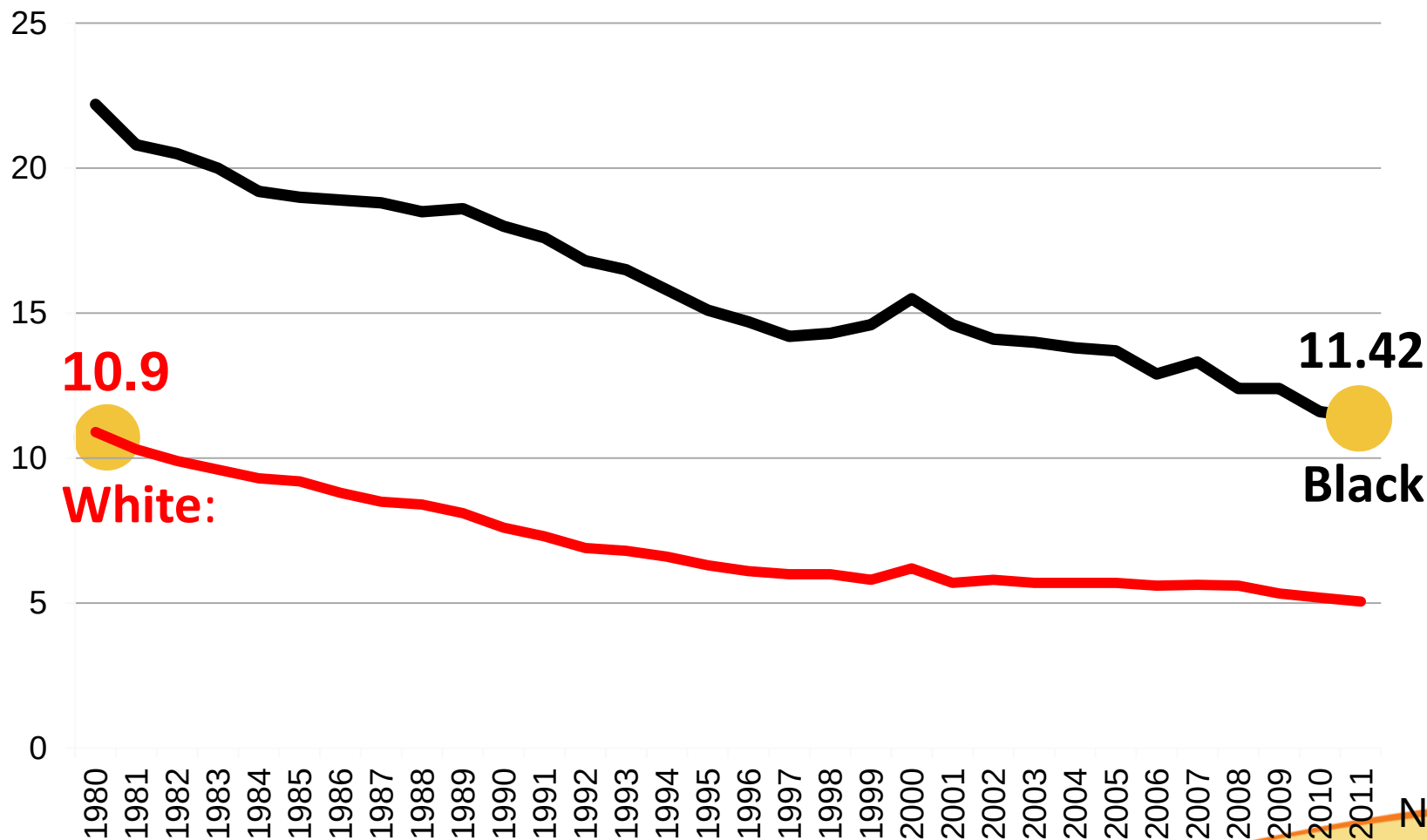


Epiphany

...a sudden, intuitive perception of or insight into the reality or essential meaning of something, usually initiated by some simple, homely, or commonplace occurrence or experience.

• Oxford Dictionaries · © Oxford University Press

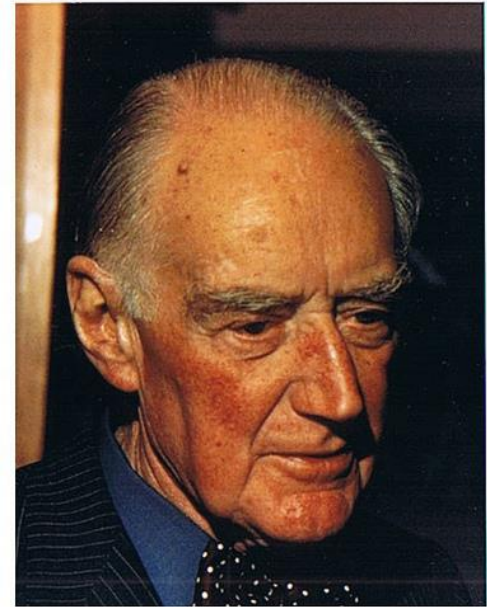
USA White and Black IMR: 1980-2011



"What Sets the Goals of Public Health?"

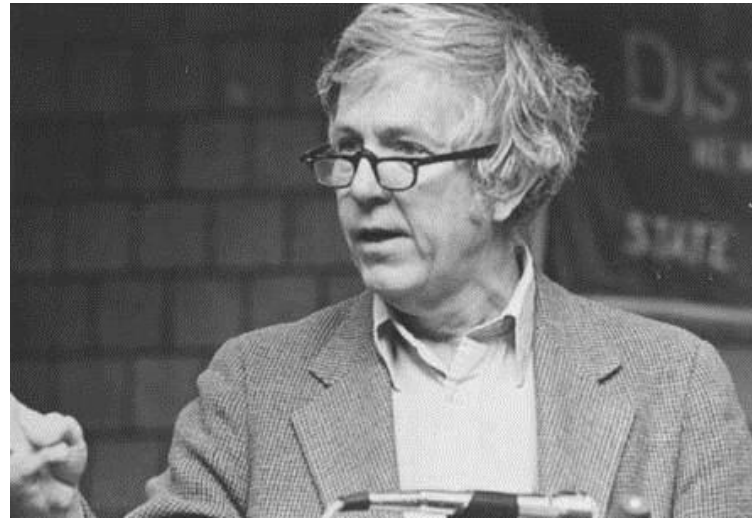
Sir Geoffrey Vickers

"The landmarks of political, economic and social history are the moments when some condition passed from the category of the given into the category of the intolerable. I believe that the history of public health might well be written as a record of successive re-definings of the unacceptable."



Edward Michael Harrington

February 24, 1928 – July 31, 1989



President Lyndon B. Johnson – State of the Union Address

January 4, 1965

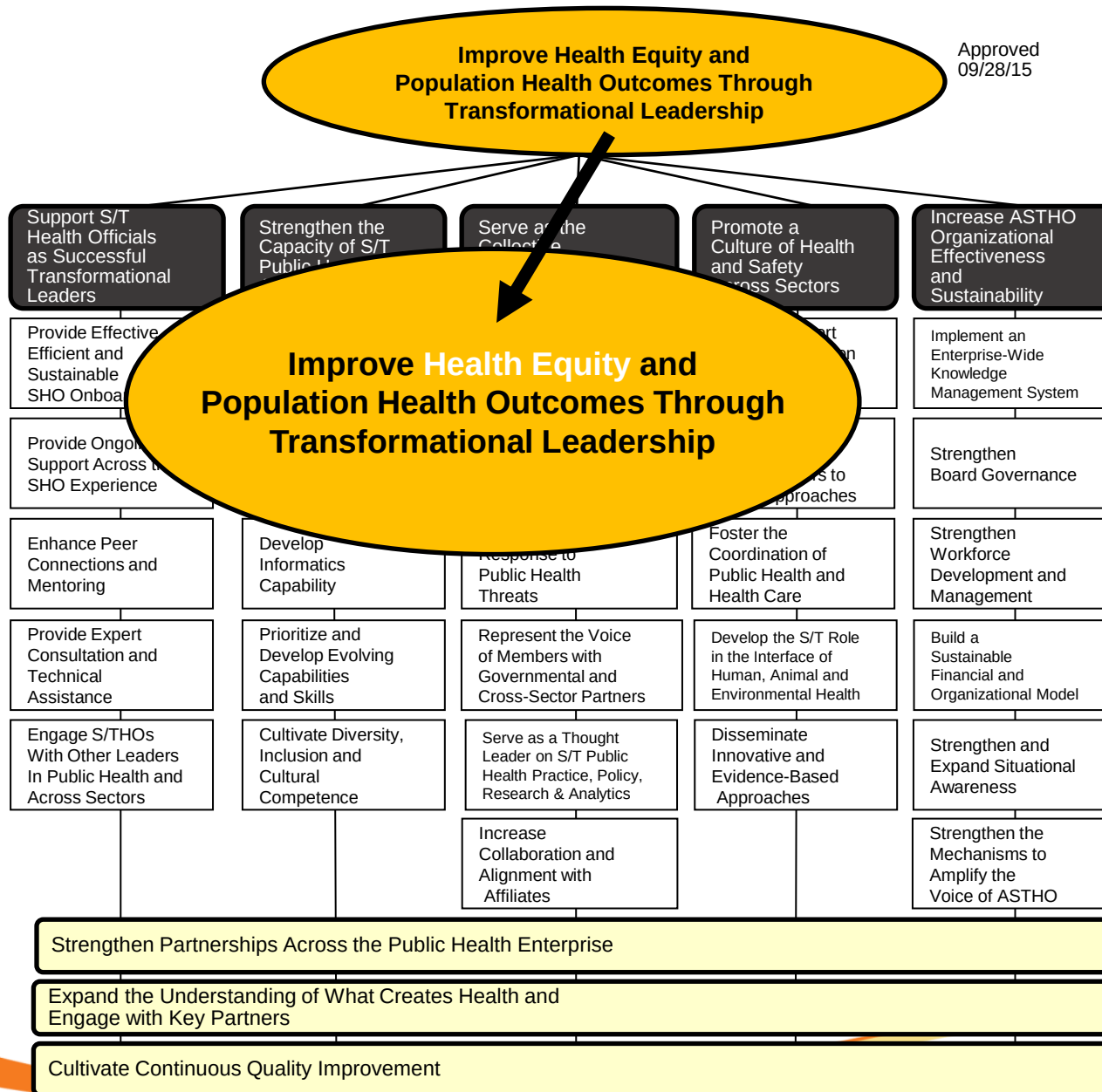
Outlined Great Society Program/War on Poverty

1965 - 89th Congress

- Head Start
- Medicare and Medicaid
- Neighborhood health centers
- Food stamps
- The Voting Rights Act
- Job Corps
- VISTA
- Peace Corps
- School lunch program
- Older Americans Act
- Elementary & Higher Education Act
- Housing & Urban Development Act
- Vocational Rehabilitation Act
- The Freedom of Information Act
- Cigarette labeling and advertising act
- Public Works and Economic Development Act
- National Foundation on the Arts and the Humanities Act
- Immigration and Nationality Act
- Motor Vehicle Air Pollution Control Act,
- Highway Beautification Act,
- National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act
- National Historic Preservation Act,
- National Wildlife Refuge System Act,
- Department of Transportation Act,
- Etc.

Association of State and Territorial Health Officials

Strategic Map: 2016-2018



ASTHO Central Challenge

Health Equity
is the Central
Challenge for
the U. S.

Multiple
efforts
underway.

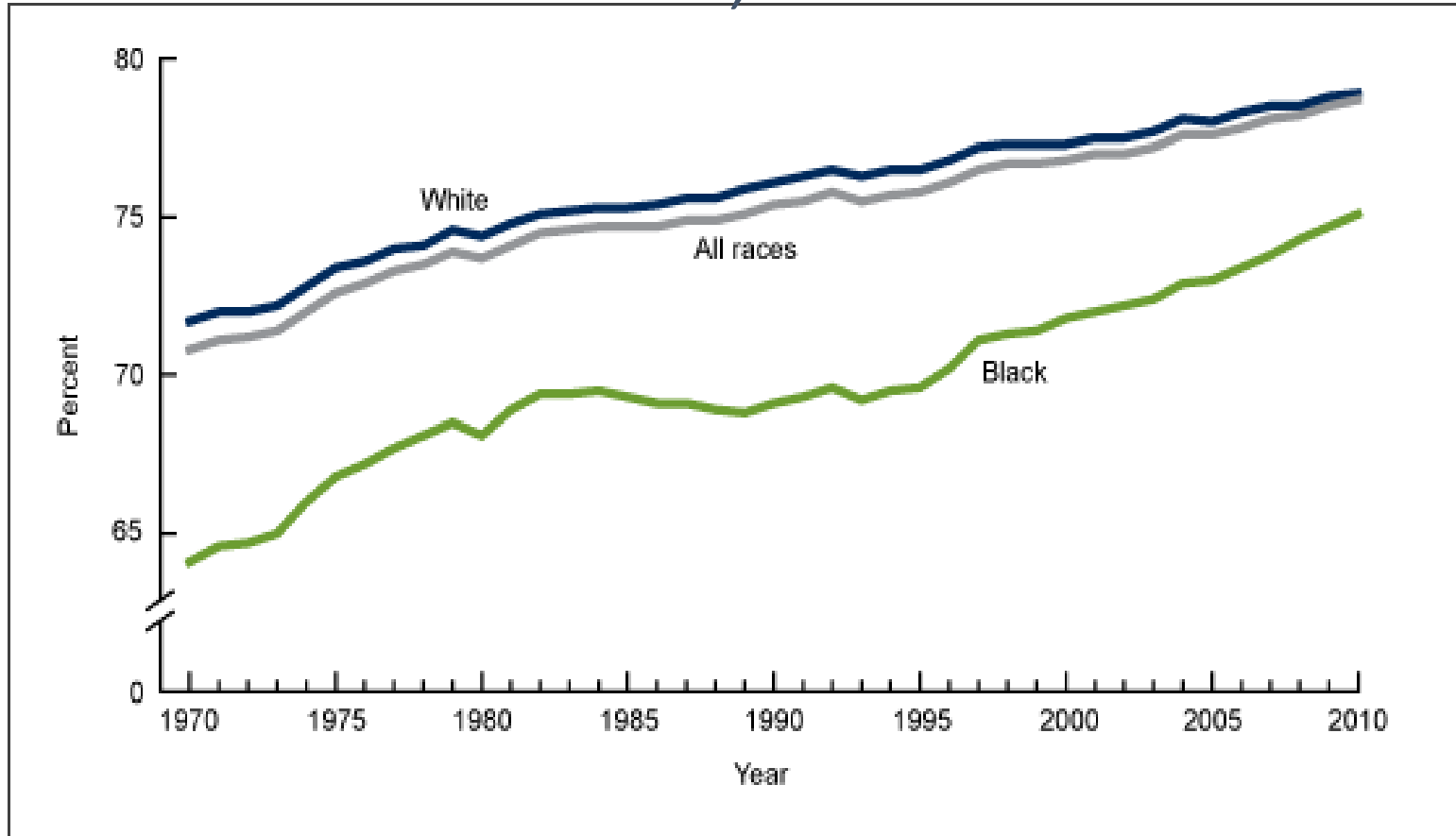
Why should people care about health equity?



- *“Injustice anywhere is a threat to justice everywhere.”*

- Letter from Birmingham Jail, April 16, 1963

Life expectancy, by race: United States, 1970–2010



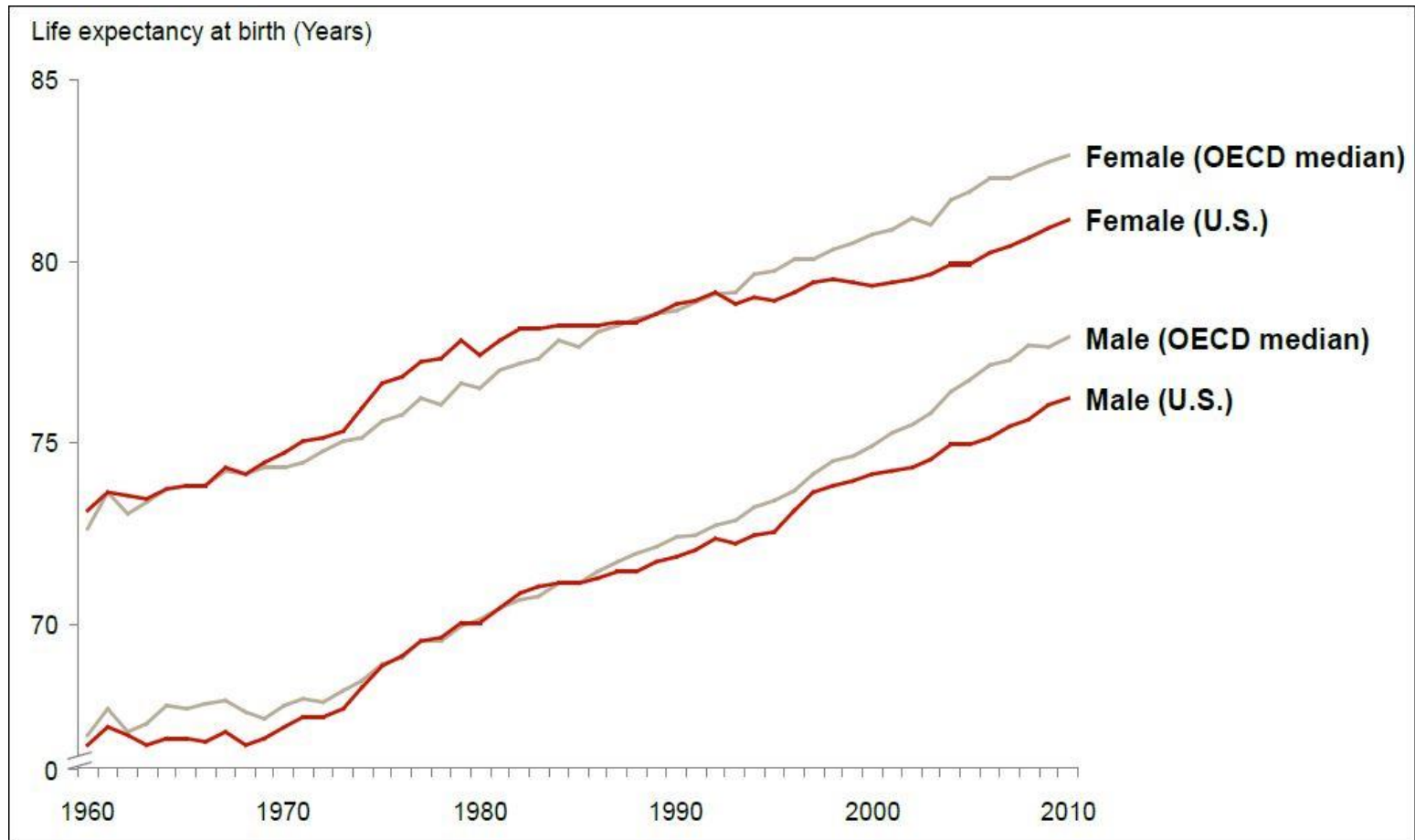
SOURCE: CDC/NCHS, National Vital Statistics System, Mortality.

“Injustice anywhere...

Disparities Affect the Health of Everyone

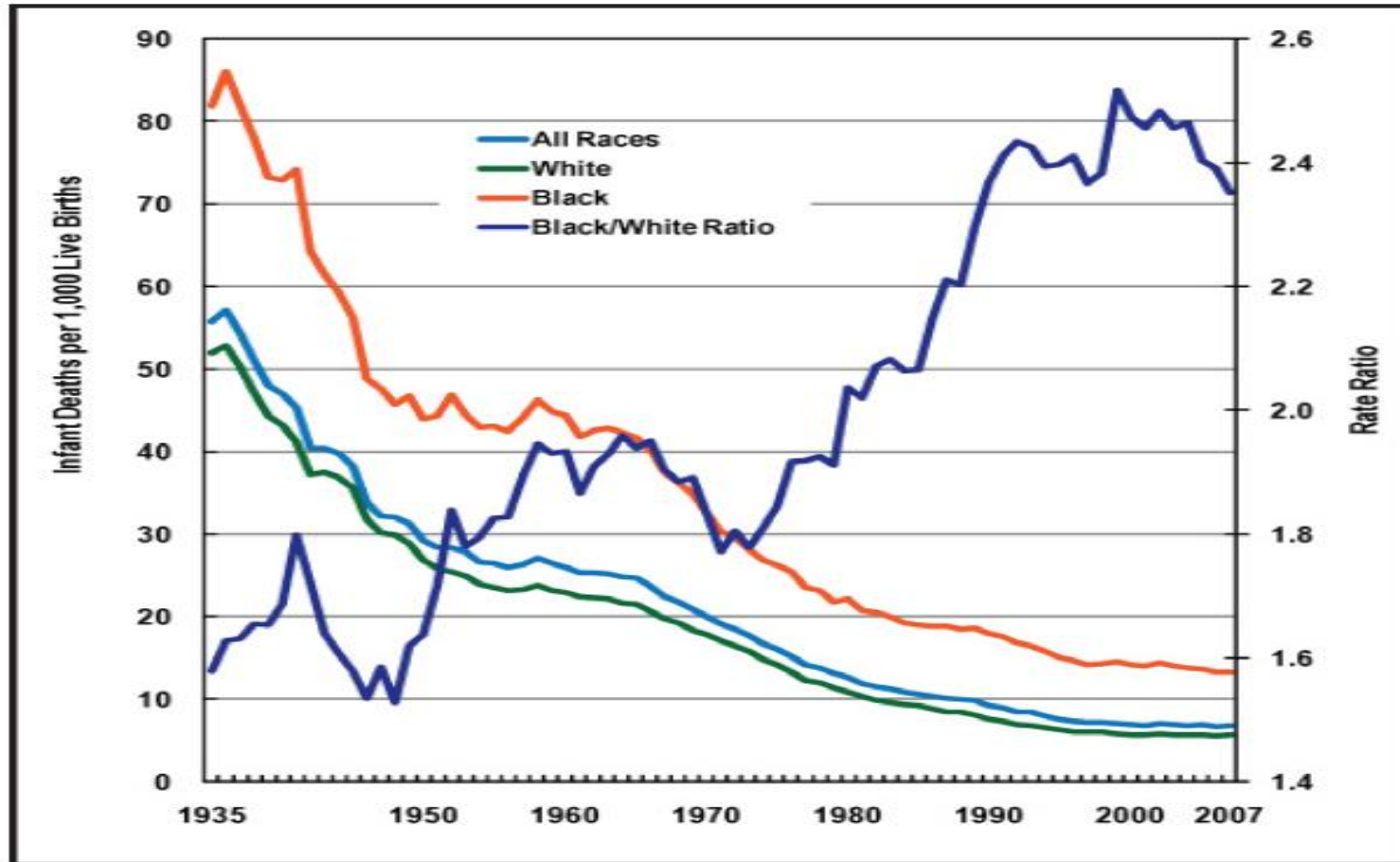
Trend in Life Expectancy at Birth

US and OECD Countries by Gender



...is a threat to justice everywhere."

Infant Mortality Rates by Race, US, 1935 - 2007



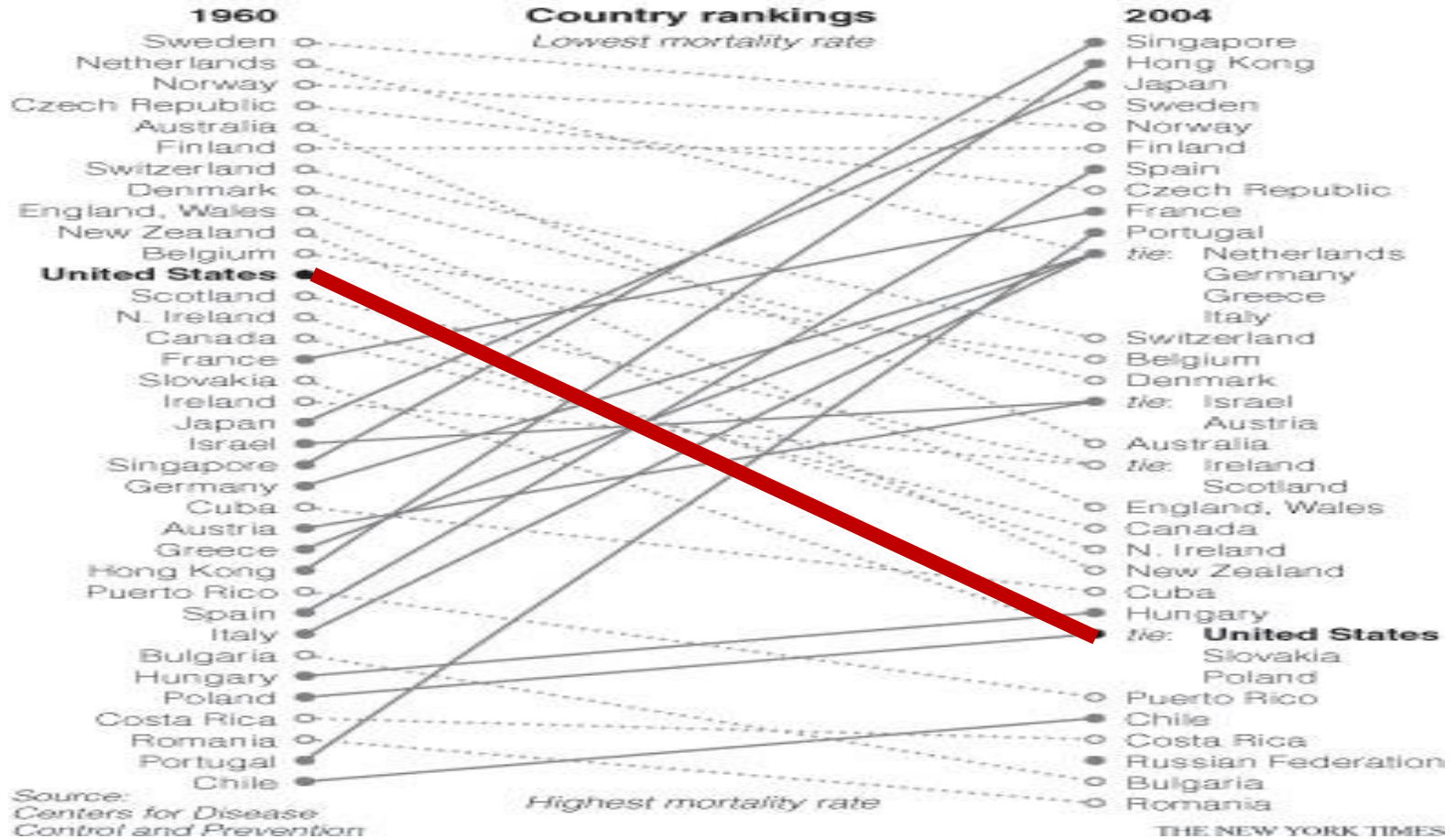
National Center for Health Statistics, Health United States, 2009 (updated)

“Injustice anywhere...

Disparities Affect the Health of Everyone

Rankings of Infant Mortality

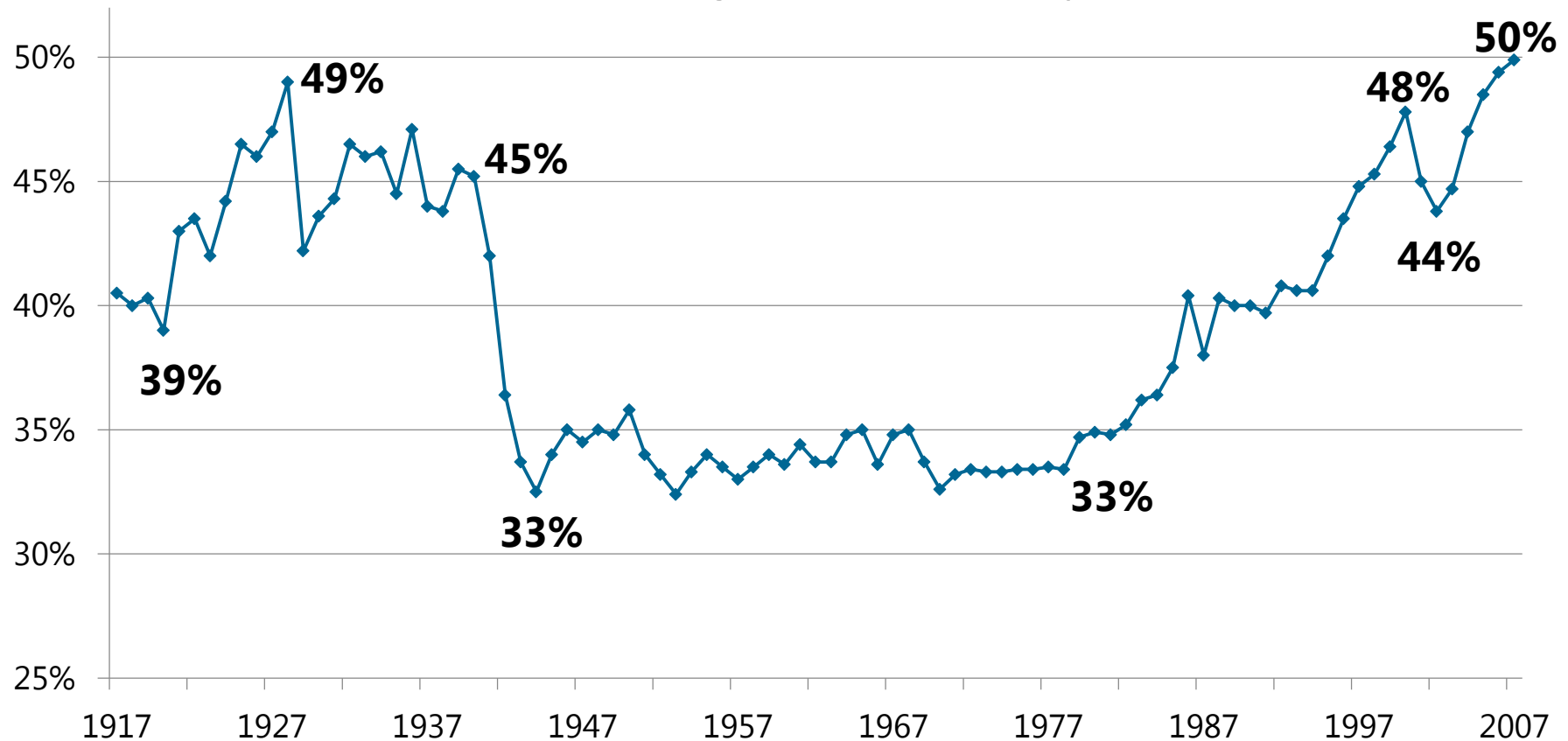
A new report ranks the United States 29th for infant mortality, tied with Slovakia and Poland. In 1960 the United States was ranked 12th.



...is a threat to justice everywhere.”

Top Decile Income Share in the United States, 1917-2007

Growing income disparity

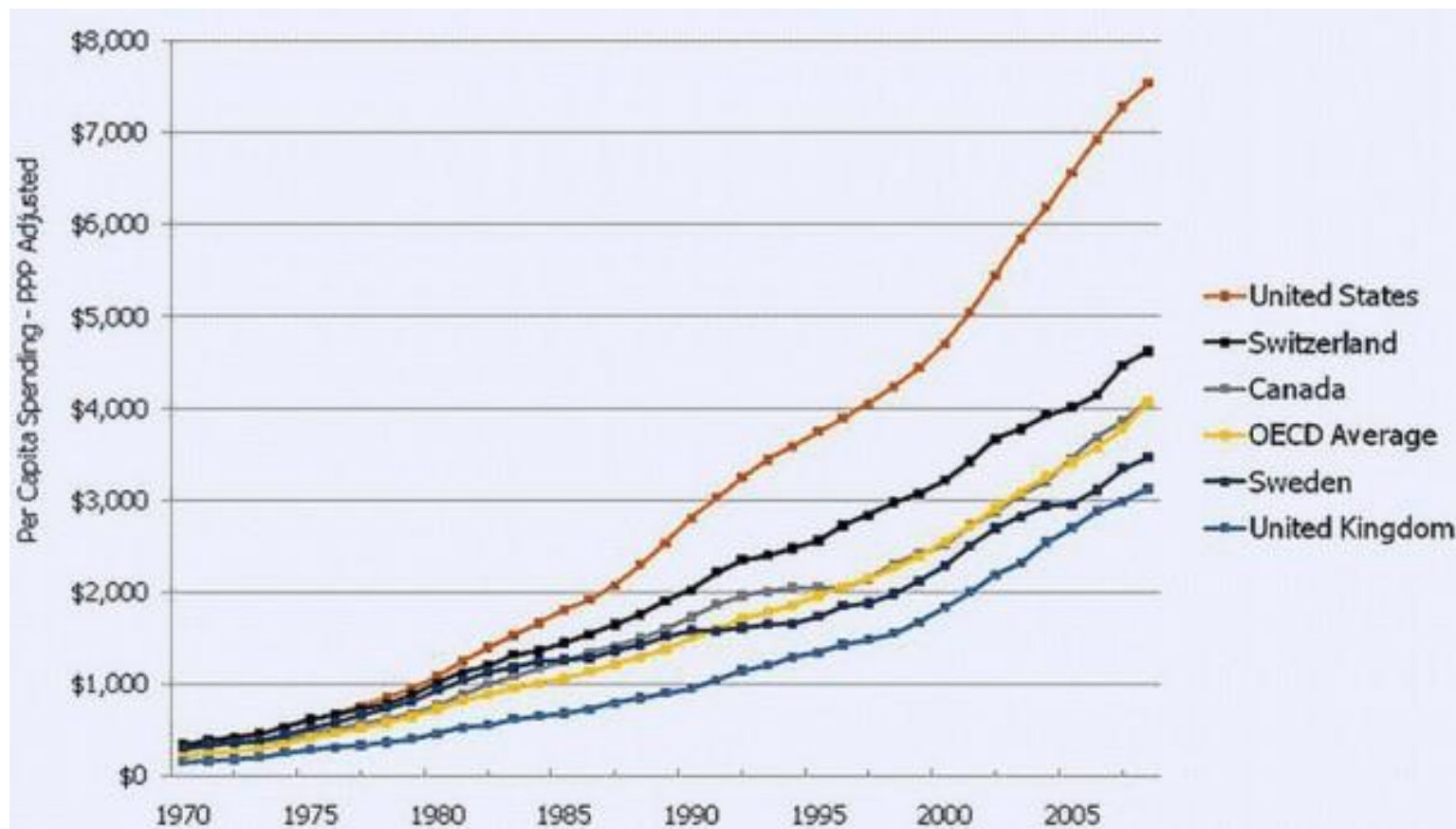


In 2007, top decile includes all U.S. families with annual income above \$109,600.

Sources: Piketty & Saez (2003), series updated to 2007, *Journal of Economic Literature*, Vol. XLIX (Mar-11)

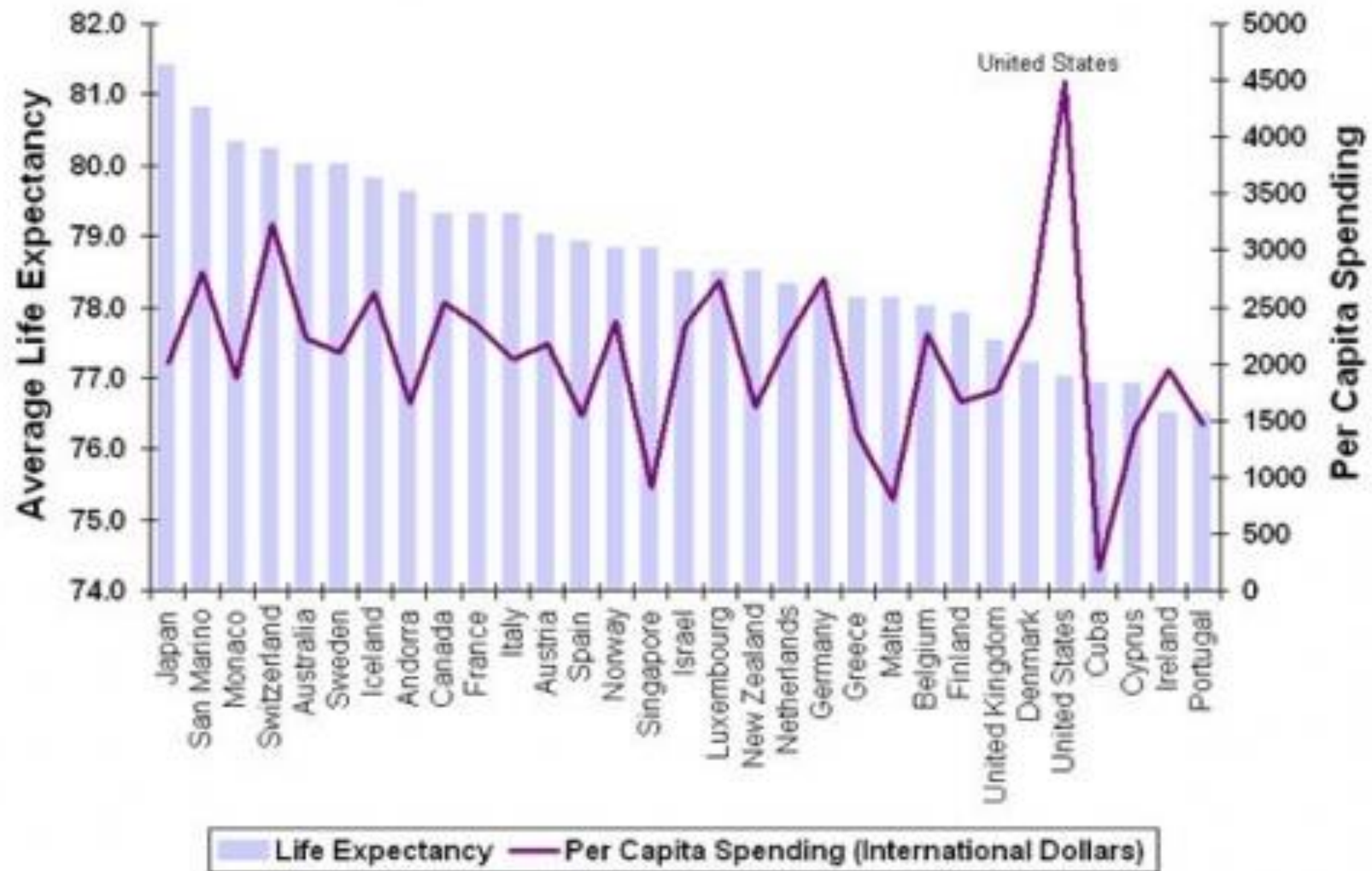
Average Health Care Spending per Capita, 1970-2009

(Adjusted for differences in cost of living)



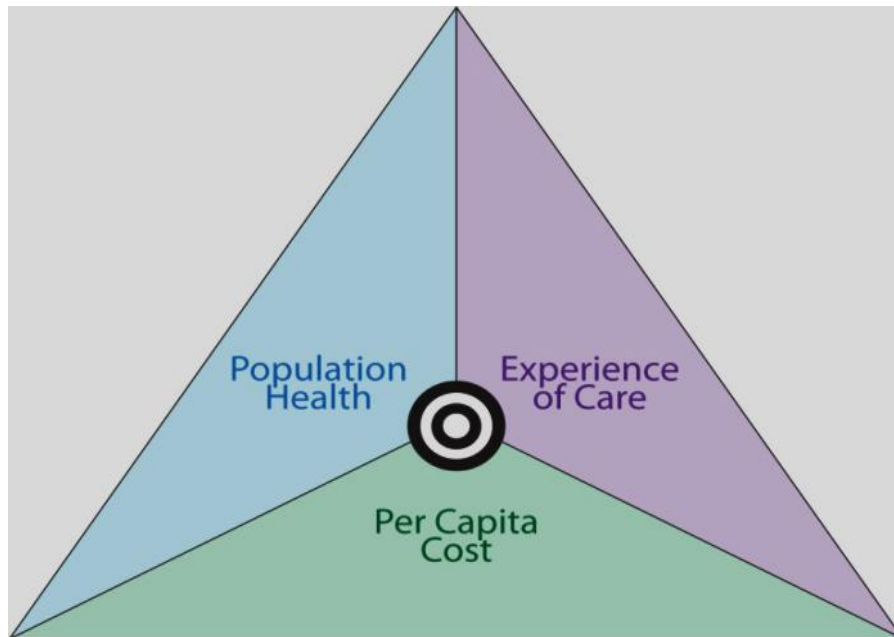
Source: OECD Health Data 2011 (June 2011)

The Cost of a Long Life



Triple Aim of Healthcare

- Better care for individuals
- Lower per capita costs
- Better health for populations



By itself, the Triple Aim of Healthcare
has not moved us to health or health equity

- Individual health model – not a community health model
- What's good for healthcare may not be what's best for communities or advancing health equity
- Healthcare has become the benevolent dictator of health
- Healthcare reinforces the narrative about what creates health

Advancing Health Equity and Optimal Health for All

Triple Aim of Health Equity

 Implement a Health in All Policies Approach With Health Equity as the Goal

 Expand Our Understanding of What Creates Health

 Strengthen the Capacity of Communities to Create Their Own Healthy Future

**Implement
Health in All Policies**

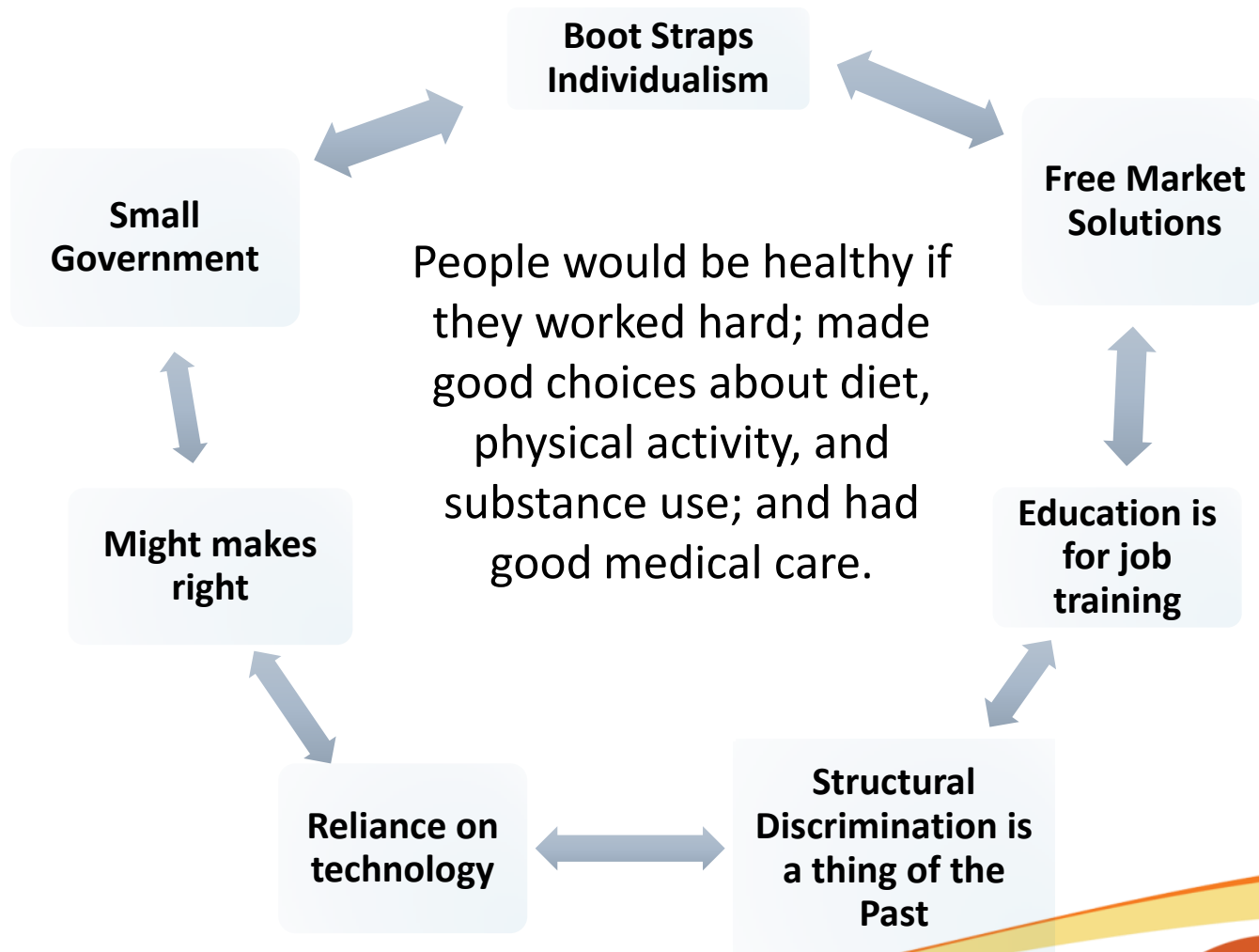
**Social
Cohesion**

**Strengthen
Community
Capacity**

**Expand
Understanding
of Health**

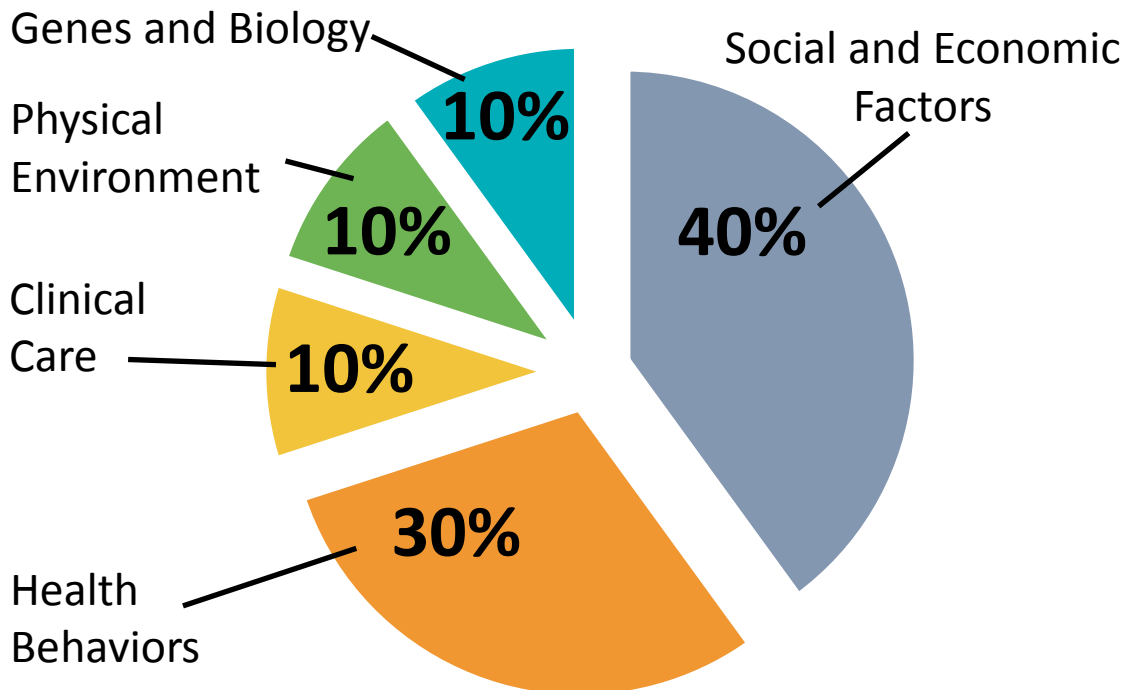
What Creates Our Understanding about What Creates Health?

Our Worldview



Expand the Understanding of What Creates Health

Determinants of Health



Necessary conditions for health (WHO)

- Peace
- Shelter
- Education
- Food
- Income
- Stable eco-system
- Sustainable resources
- Mobility
- Health Care
- Social justice and equity

Determinants of Health Model based on frameworks developed by: Tarlov AR. *Ann N Y Acad Sci* 1999; 896: 281-93; and Kindig D, Asada Y, Booske B. *JAMA* 2008; 299(17): 2081-2083.

World Health Organization. Ottawa charter for health promotion. International Conference on Health Promotion: The Move Towards a New Public Health, November 17-21, 1986 Ottawa, Ontario, Canada, 1986. Accessed July 12, 2002 at <http://www.who.int/hpr/archive/docs/ottawa.html>.

Communities of Opportunity

- Social/economic inclusion
- Thriving small businesses and entrepreneurs
- Financial institutions
- Good transportation options and infrastructure
- Home ownership
- Better performing schools
- Sufficient healthy housing
- Grocery stores
- IT connectivity
- Strong local governance
- Parks & trails

Good Health Status

Poor Health Status

Contributes to health disparities:

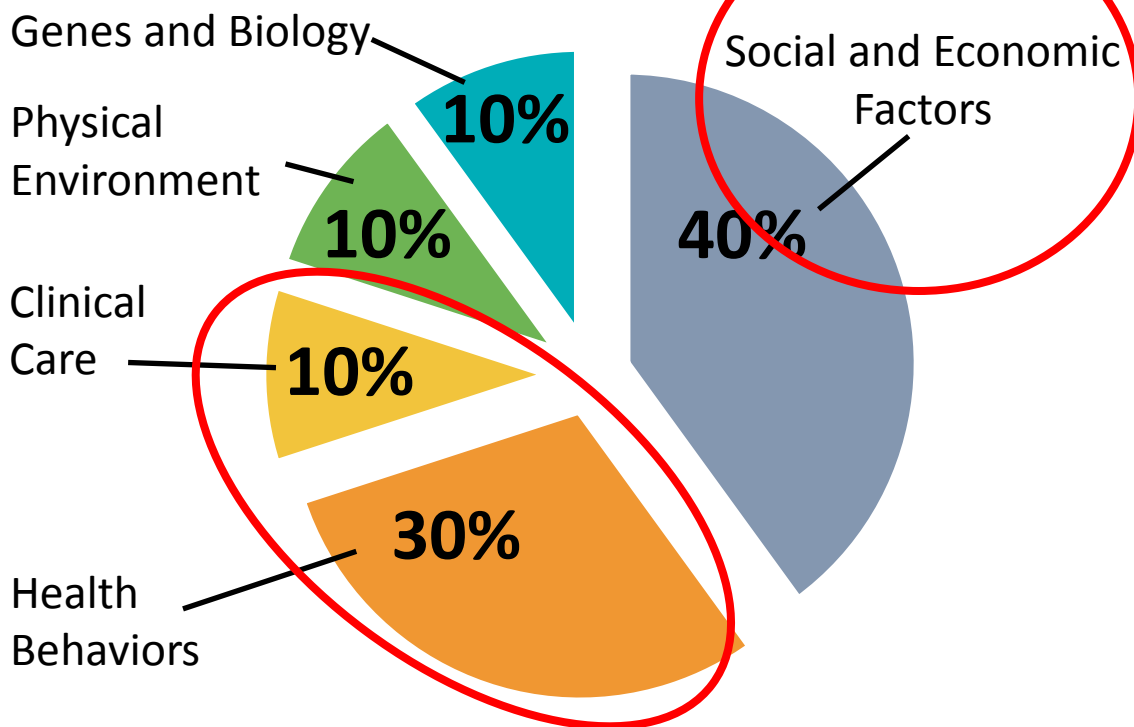
- Diabetes
- Cancer
- Asthma
- Obesity
- Injury

Low-Opportunity Communities

- Social/economic exclusion
- Few small businesses
- Payday lenders
- Few transportation options
- Rental housing/foreclosure
- Poor performing schools
- Poor and limited housing stock
- Increased pollution and contaminated drinking water
- Fast food restaurants
- Limited IT connections
- Weak local governance
- Unsafe/limited parks

Expand the Understanding of What Creates Health

Determinants of Health



Determinants are created & enhanced by policies and systems that impact the physical and social environment

Determinants of Health Model based on frameworks developed by: Tarlov AR. *Ann N Y Acad Sci* 1999; 896: 281-93; and Kindig D, Asada Y, Booske B. *JAMA* 2008; 299(17): 2081-2083.

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And The Real Narrative of What Creates Health Inequities?



- Disparities are not just because of lack of access to health care or to poor individual choices.
- **Disparities are mostly the result of policy decisions that systematically disadvantage some populations over others.**
 - Especially, populations of color and American Indians, GLBT, immigrants, and refugees
 - Structural Racism



Asking the Right Questions About Assumptions Can Help Change the Narrative

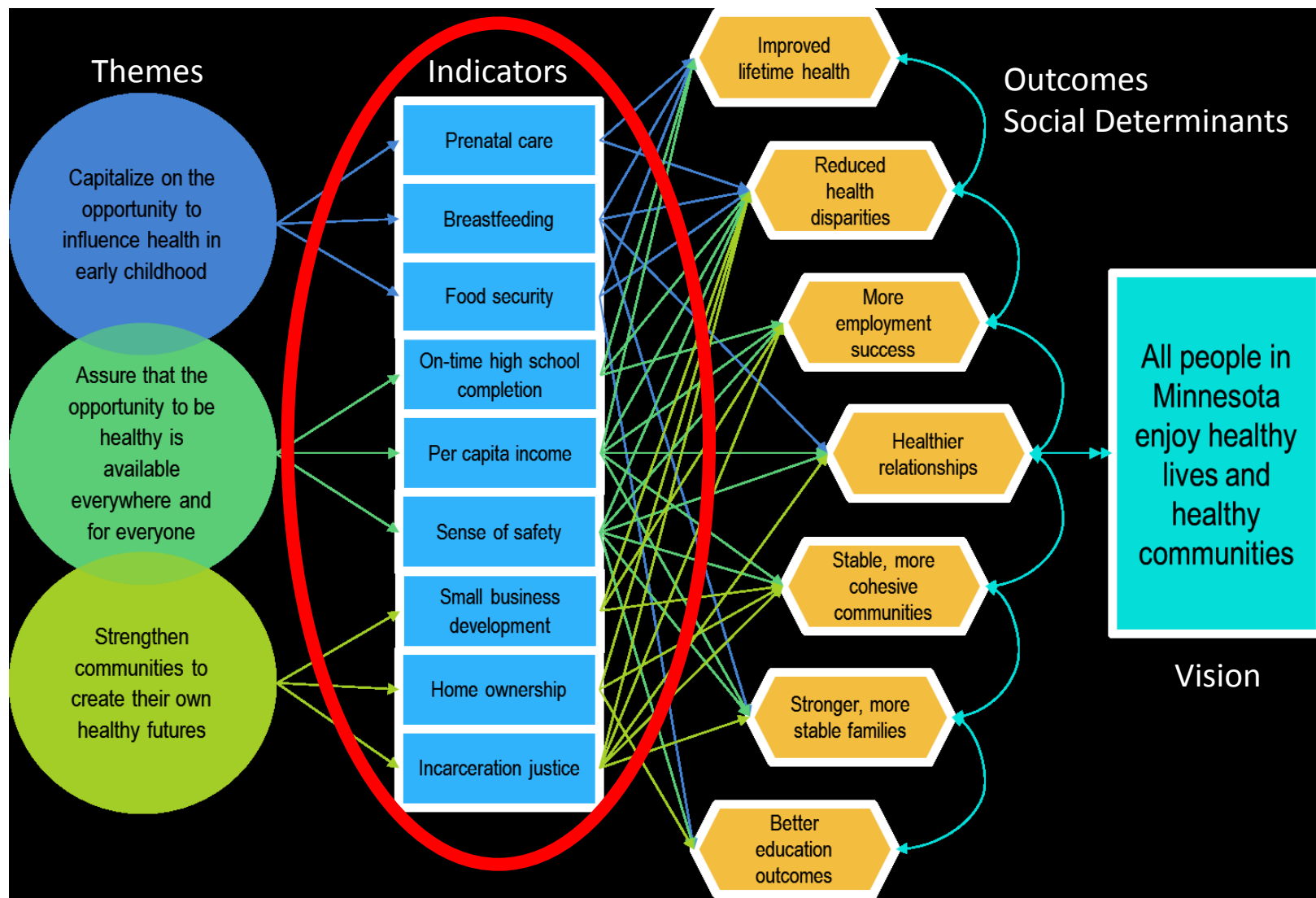
- *What values underlie the decision-making process?*
- *What is assumed to be true about the world and the role of the institution in the world?*
- *What standards of success are being applied at different decision points, and by whom?*



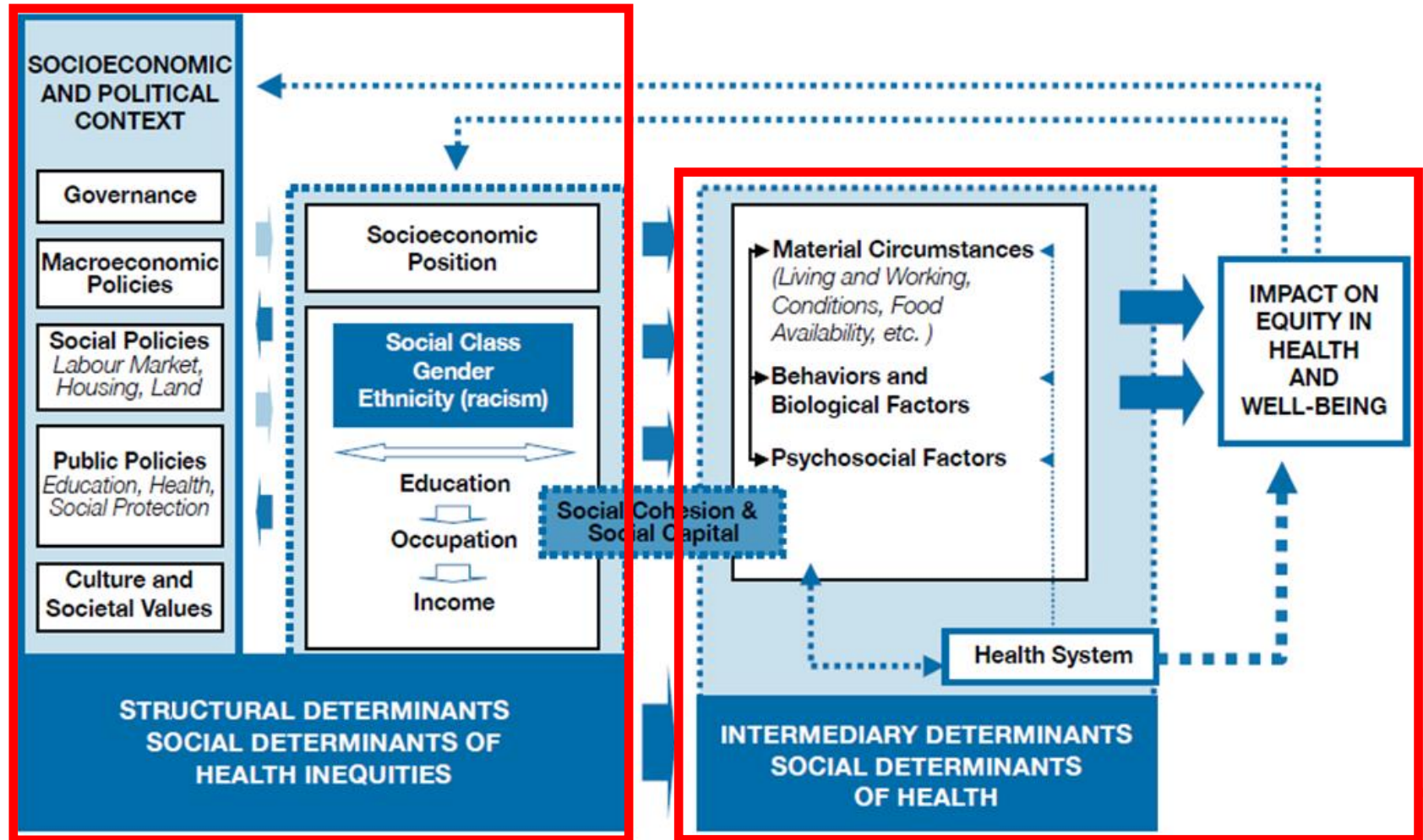
Tools for Expanding Our Understanding of What Creates Health

- Indicators of what creates health included in Statewide Health Assessment
- Expanded group of partners in developing Statewide Health Improvement Plan
- Health Equity Report
- REL Data
- ACEs (adverse childhood experiences)

Change the Narrative about What Creates Health Indicators in Statewide Health Assessment/Framework



Implement Health in All Policies Approach with Health Equity as a Goal



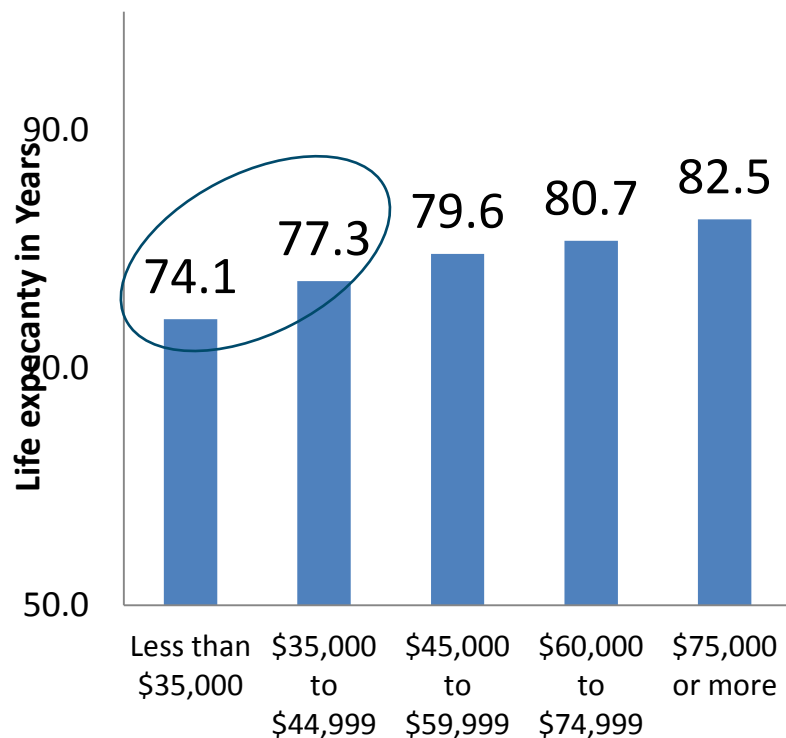
Commission on Social Determinants of Health. (2010). *A conceptual framework for action on the social determinants of health*. Geneva: World Health Organization.

Policy and System Changes Related to Social Determinants of Health (selected)

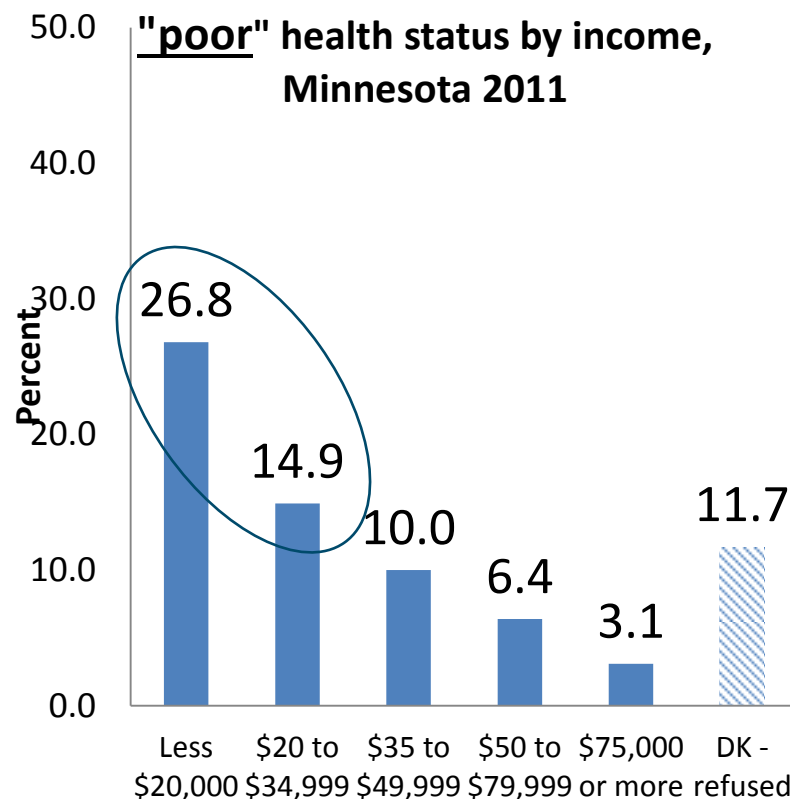


- Minimum Wage
- Paid Leave
- Transportation Policy
- REL data
- Broadband connectivity
- E-Health Policies
- Buffer strips – Ag policy
- Marriage Equity
- Ban the Box – post incarceration issues
- State Agency Policy Changes
- University Research/Training objectives

Life expectancy by median household income group of ZIP codes, Twin Cities 1998-2002



Adults 18-64 reporting "fair" or "poor" health status by income, Minnesota 2011



Source: The unequal distribution of health in the Twin Cities, Wilder Research www.wilderresearch.org
 Analyses were conducted by Wilder Research using 1998-2002 mortality data from the Minnesota Department of Health and data from the U.S. Census Bureau (population, median household income, and poverty rate by ZIP code)

Source: 2011 Behavioral Risk Factor Surveillance System



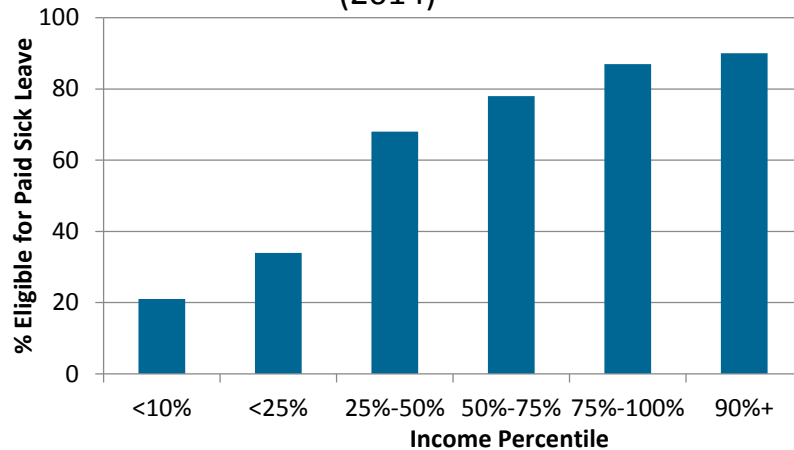
Paid Parental and Sick Leave Linked to Improvements in:

- Infant mortality
- Health of infants and mothers
- Breastfeeding
- Vaccinations
- Well child check-ups
- Maternal depression
- Occupational injuries
- Routine cancer screenings
- Emergency room usage
- Days lost due to illness



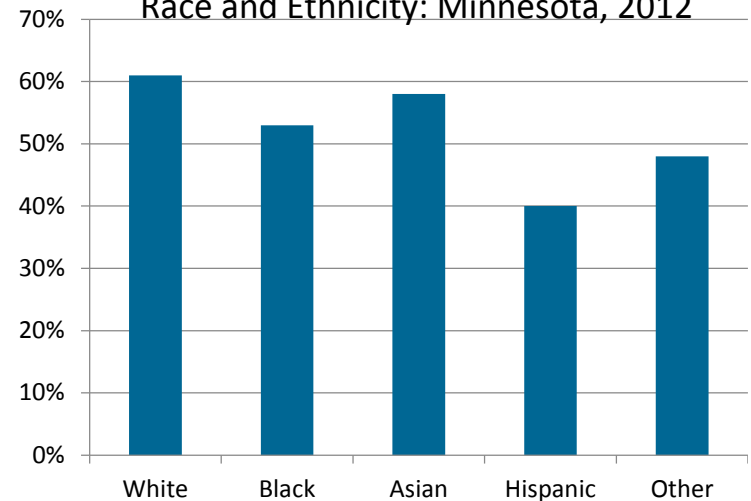
Disparities in Access to Paid Sick Leave

Access to Paid Sick Leave by Income -
Rates for All Civilian Employees, U.S.
(2014)



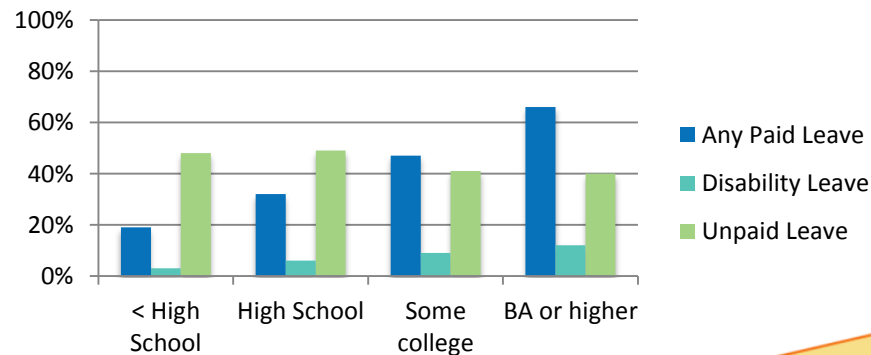
Source: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics

Access to Paid Sick Leave by
Race and Ethnicity: Minnesota, 2012



Source: Institute of Women's Policy Research

Mothers' Access to Paid Leave by Education:
U.S. 2006-2008



Source: U.S. Census



Asking the right policy questions helps support a Health in All Policies approach

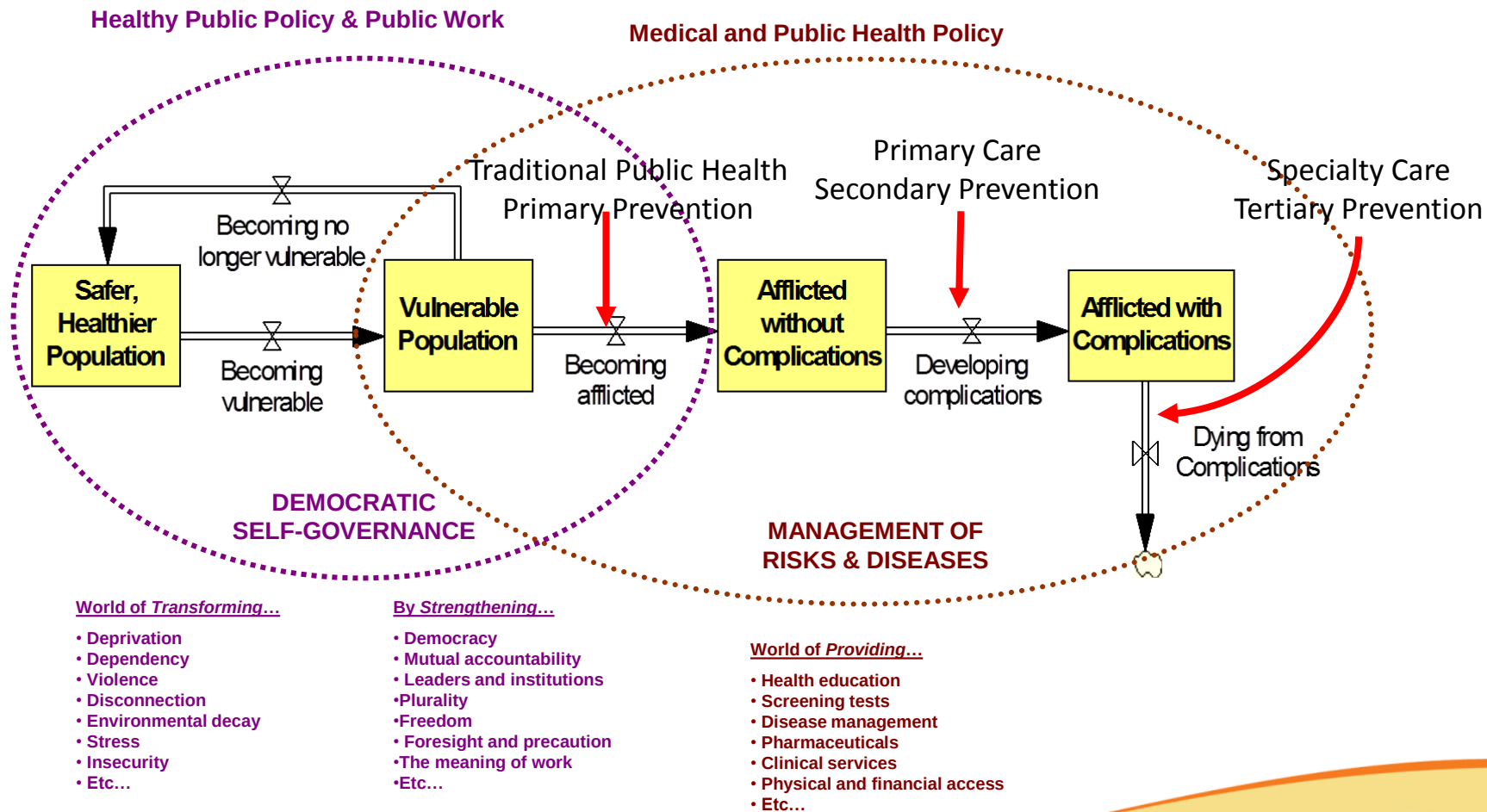
- *What are the health implications of the policy/program?*
- *What are the health and equity outcomes?*
- *What outcomes do we want?*
- *Who is benefiting?*
- *Who is left out?*
- *Who should be targeted to benefit?*



Tool kit for HiAP with Health Equity as the Goal

- State-wide Health Improvement Plans including a HiAP type of goal
- State funders support HiAP or HIA's
- White papers on the connection between health and key conditions for health
- Internal Policies alignment
- Engagement of all cabinet members
- Accountable Communities for Health

Strengthen the Capacity of Communities to Create Their Own Healthy Future



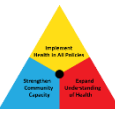
Health is Community



Accountable
Communities of
Health

“...the community in the fullest sense is the smallest unit of health...to speak of the health of an isolated individual is a contradiction in terms.”

Wendell Berry in Health is Membership



Asking the right policy questions helps strengthen community capacity to create their own healthy future

- *Who is at the decision-making table, and who is not?*
- *Who has the power at the table?*
- *How should the decision-making table be set, and who should set it?*
- *Who is being held accountable and to whom or what are they accountable?*

Policy Tool Kit for Strengthening the Capacity of Communities to Create Their Own Healthy Future



- Community health indicators
- Community engagement plan
- Stakeholder identification including interests
- Community governance models
- Advisory and Community Leadership Teams
- Community input on grant criteria
- Community benefit accountability



Other Tools for Health Departments and Other Agencies

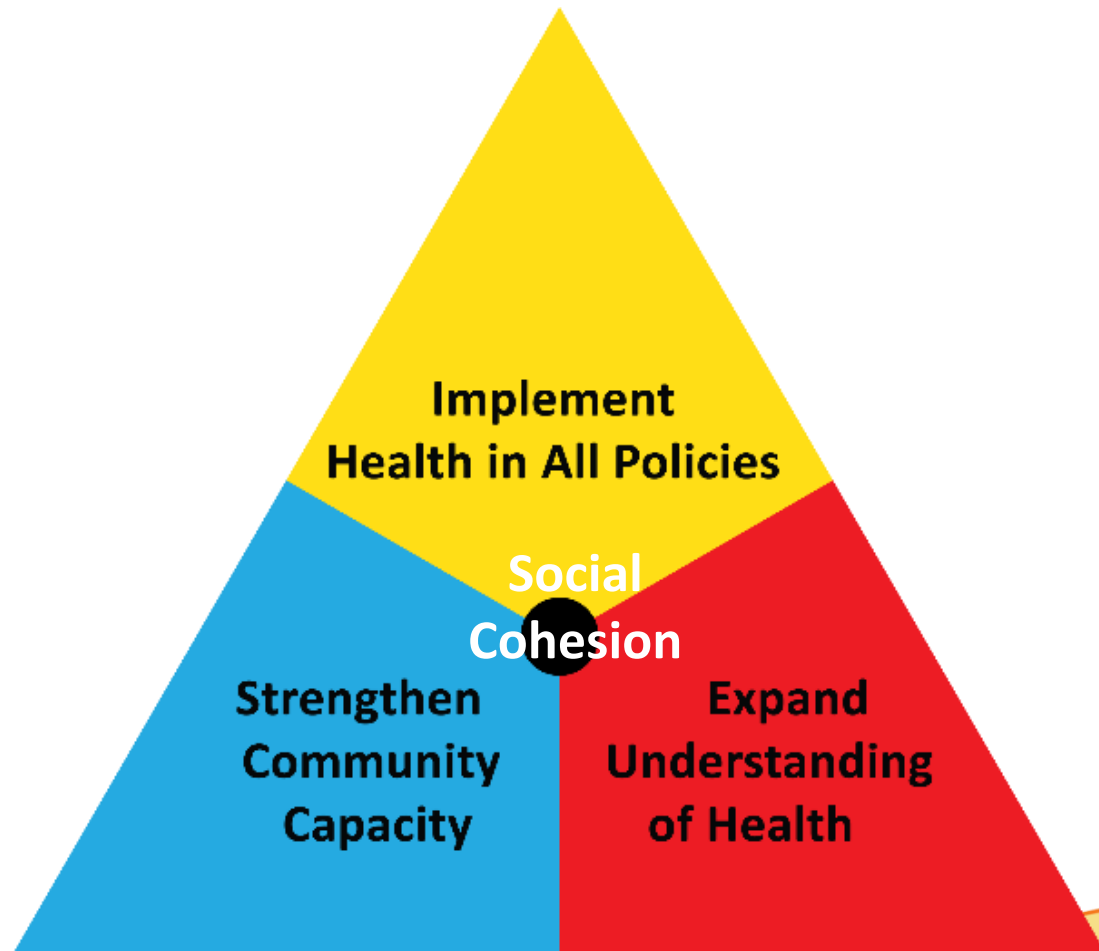
- Organizational Strategies for Moving Forward – Strategic Plan
- Health Equity Assessment of Organizational Capacity to Advance Health Equity



Asking the Right Questions Is a Path to Health Equity and Optimal Health for All

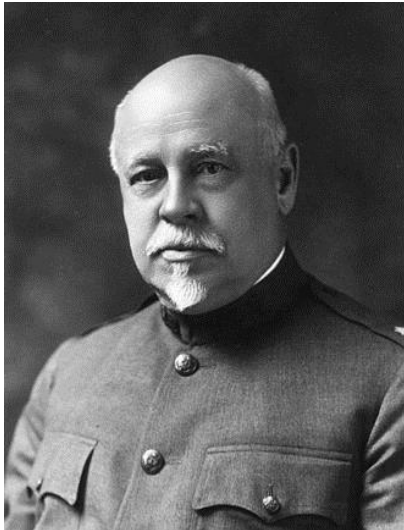
- *What would it look like if equity was the starting point for decision-making?*
- *Our work would be different.*

Our Work Would be to Advance Health Equity and Optimal Health for All By:



1915 Welch-Rose Report

Laid foundation for Schools of Public Health



William Henry Welch



Wickliff Rose

The Welch-Rose report:
“...unity is to be found in the end to be
accomplished.”

Abraham Flexner

1910 Flexner Report

“...the physician’s function is fast becoming social and preventive, rather than individual and curative...(do) not to forget that directly or indirectly, disease has been found to depend largely on unpropitious environment...a bad water supply, defective drainage, impure food, unfavorable occupational surroundings...(these) are matters for “social regulation,” and doctors have the duty to promote social conditions that conduce to physical well-being.”

C.E.A. Winslow,
Dean, Yale School of Public Health
Public Health (1920):

The science and art of :
1. **Preventing** disease.
2. **Prolonging** life, and
3. **Promoting** health and
efficiency through **organized
community** effort for:



continued

Winslow – definition of public health continued

- a. the **sanitation** of the environment,
- b. the control of **communicable infections**,
- c. the **education** of the individual in personal hygiene,
- d. the **organization** of medical and nursing services for the early diagnosis and preventive treatment of disease, and
- e. the development of the **social machinery** to insure everyone a **standard of living** adequate for the maintenance of health, so **organizing these benefits** as to enable **every citizen to realize his birthright of health and longevity**.

Integrate medicine and public health

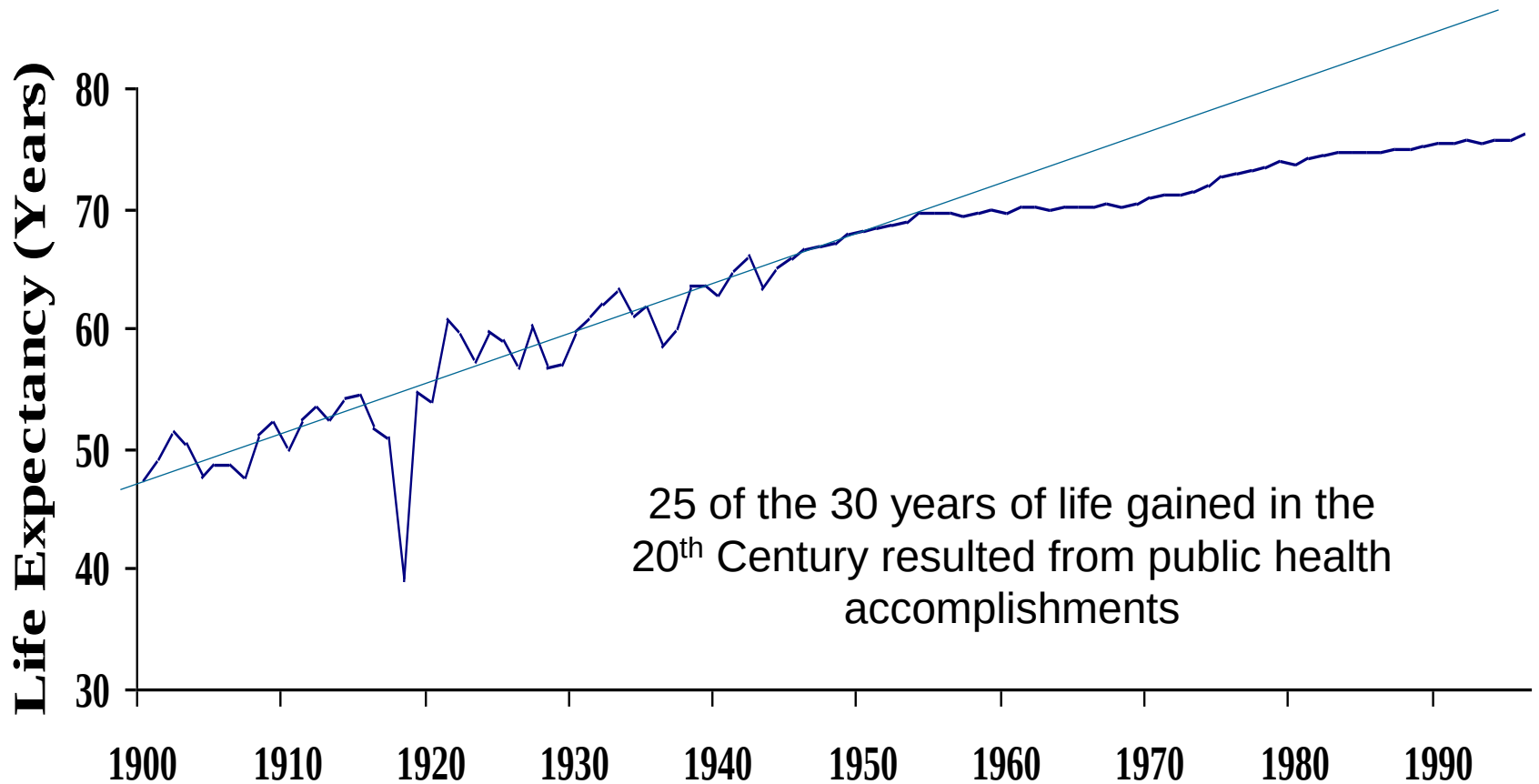
- *I swear by Apollo, the healer, Asclepius, Hygieia, and Panacea, and I take to witness all the gods, all the goddesses, to keep according to my ability and my judgment, the following Oath and agreement...*



Asclepius and Hygieia

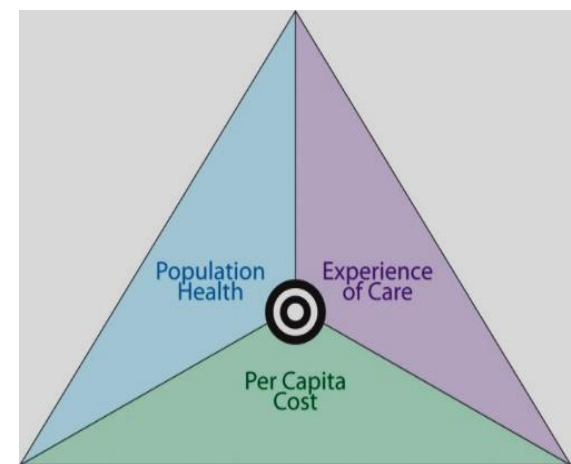
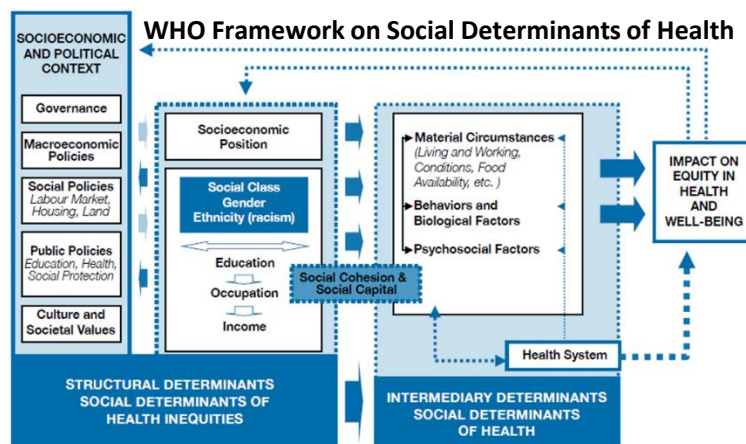
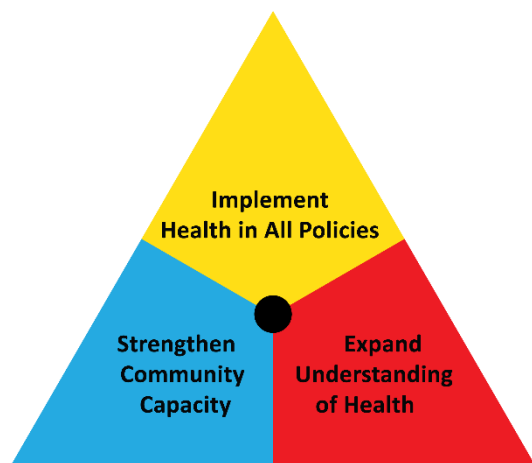
Original Hippocratic Oath

Life Expectancy at Birth, United States, 1900 - 1996



Most of the Gains were due to a Health in All Policies approach with the integration of Public Health and Medical Care

Public Policies – Community/Public Health – Healthcare Essential in Advancing Health Equity and Optimal Health for All



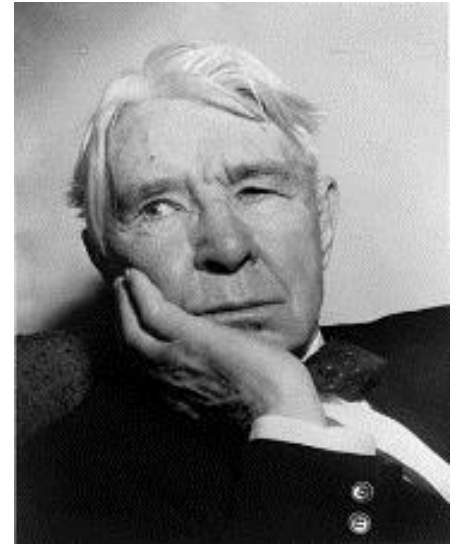
Triple Aim of Health Equity

- Expand the understanding of what creates health
- Implement a Health in All Policies approach with health equity as the goal
- Strengthen the capacity of communities to create their own healthy future

- *“Nothing happens unless first a dream.”*

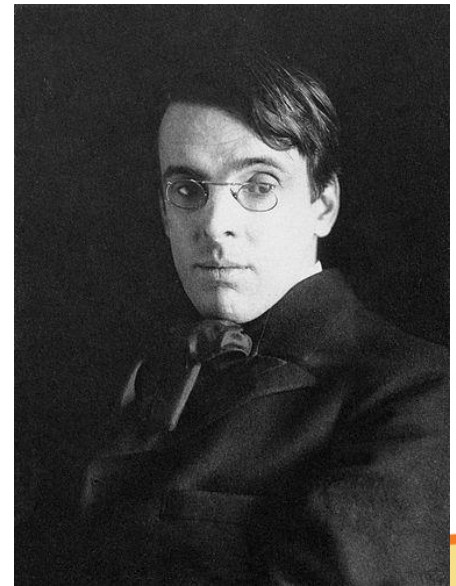
- *Carl Sandburg*

- *Born January 6, 1878*



- *“In dreams begin responsibility”*

- *William Butler Yeats*



“Public health is what we, as a society, do collectively to assure the conditions in which (all) people can be healthy.”

-Institute of Medicine (1988), Future of Public Health

Edward P. Ehlinger, MD, MSPH

Commissioner, MDH

President, ASTHO

P.O. Box 64975

St. Paul, MN 55164-0975

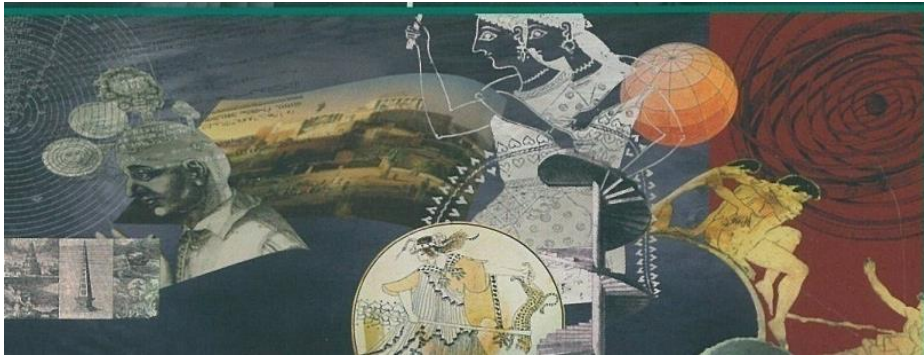
Ed.ehlinger@state.mn.us



Health is essential to the success of our society

- *“When health is absent, wisdom cannot reveal itself, art cannot become manifest, strength cannot fight, wealth becomes useless, and intelligence cannot be applied.”*

- Herophilus of Chalcedon, 335-280 BCE
- Physician to Alexander the Great



The success of all sectors of our society is essential to our health

- *“Health is absent when wisdom cannot reveal itself, art cannot become manifest, strength cannot fight, wealth becomes useless, and intelligence cannot be applied.”*

- Ed Ehlinger, 12/10/2015 CE

- Physician to the State of Minnesota

